

Monthly running cost with cloud hosting (integrated into the pitch)

Here's an updated, concrete view of **monthly running cost if you fully host on cloud (compute + DB + storage)** for ~200–300 active MSME customers:

1) Core infrastructure (per month)

- **Application server (API + frontend)**
 - 1–2 small VMs / containers (e.g. AWS Lightsail / DigitalOcean / Render)
 - ₹3,000–₹8,000 / month
- **Managed database (PostgreSQL/MySQL)**
 - Single small instance with automated backups
 - ₹4,000–₹10,000 / month
- **Cloud object storage (logos, PDFs, exports)**

(e.g. S3/Spaces/B2 – few GBs + traffic)

- **Storage: ₹200–₹800 / month**
- **Bandwidth: ₹500–₹2,000 / month** (depends on downloads)
- **Backups & monitoring**
 - Snapshots, metrics, log retention, uptime checks
 - ₹1,000–₹3,000 / month

Subtotal infra (200–300 customers): 👉 ~₹8,700 to ₹23,800 / month

2) Application-level services

- **Email provider (when you move beyond raw Gmail SMTP)**
 - Transactional emails for orders + announcements
 - Roughly 10,000–30,000 emails / month
 - ₹2,000–₹6,000 / month
 - **WhatsApp Business API (if you upgrade from deep-link) – optional**
 - Depends on conversations; you usually pass this cost onto customers
 - Your margin could be ₹1,000–₹5,000 / month at scale if you bundle it.
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3) All-in monthly running cost (cloud-based)

For ~200–300 active customers:

- **Low estimate (lean setup):**
 - Infra (~₹9k) + email (~₹2k) ≈ ₹11k / month
 - **Realistic working estimate (with headroom + better monitoring):**
 - Infra (~₹15k) + email (~₹3–4k) ≈ ₹18k–₹20k / month
 - **Comfortable growth estimate (more replicas, more logs):**
 - Infra (~₹20k+) + email (~₹5–6k) ≈ ₹25k–₹30k / month
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How this ties back to revenue

Using the earlier base-case:

- At **250 customers** paying ₹999/month:
- Revenue ≈ ₹2.5L / month
- Cloud running cost ≈ ₹15k–₹25k / month
- Gross margin from infra alone: ~90%+